

Object Connections

Object Connections is a functionality where you can connect one type of object (entity) such as a Document or Media item, to another object such as a Customer Order or Expense Sheet. In this example the Document and Media are referred to as "services". Users can then see the connected objects/services in IFS Cloud Web and IFS Cloud Mobile in the attachments panel/group.

There are a limited set of services available and a list of the most commonly used are listed below. You can enable the object connection for any object in IFS Cloud. You will access these connections through the Attachments section in IFS Cloud Web pages.

The services can connect your objects to:

- Document Management,
- to allow Approval Routings,
- to be able to enter Characteristics,
- to access Engineering Requests and Change Order Actions
- and many more...

The ability to enable these connections is configured in IFS Solution Manager and must be done by the administrator.

Adding services is done by defining the services for an entity in the entity model.

Locating the Configuration Forms

The *Object Connections* page shows all business objects connected to certain services in the client environment. It is available in the Object Connections folder in Solution Manager.

Page Description

The page *Object Connections* is where you manage the connections. You define the combination of an LU Name, and a View Name, to map to a list of predefined services shown in Service List column. The Method Name is a function that will be invoked on the keys in the package to provide a lead text in the connection dialog. The connection will be live in all pages in the web client where the View for the specified LU is the base for the page.

Logical Unit	Description	Component	View Name	Package Name	Method Name	Service List	Default Definition
SalesPart	Sales Part	ORDER	SALES_PART	SALES_PART_API	Get_Catalog_Desc	DocReferenceObject	Yes
SupplierBlanket	Supplier Agreement	PURCH	SUPPLIER_BLANKET	SUPPLIER_BLANKET_API		DocReferenceObject	Yes
InquiryLineNoPartOrder	Inquiry Order Line NoPart	PURCH	INQUIRY_LINE_NOPART_C	INQUIRY_LINE_NOPART_C		DocReferenceObject	Yes
InquiryLinePartOrder	Inquiry Order Line Part	PURCH	INQUIRY_LINE_PART_ORD	INQUIRY_LINE_PART_ORD		DocReferenceObject	Yes
Modification	Modification	VIM	MODIFICATION	MODIFICATION_API	Get_Mod_Desc	DocReferenceObject	Yes
ShopOrderProp	Shop Order Prop	SHOPORD	SHOP_ORDER_PROP	SHOP_ORDER_PROP_API		DocReferenceObject, MediaLibrary	Yes
PurchaseOrderLinePart	Purchase Order Line Part	PURCH	PURCHASE_ORDER_LINE	PURCHASE_ORDER_LINE		DocReferenceObject	Yes
Company	Company	ENTERP	COMPANY	COMPANY_API	Get_Doc_Object_Descript	DocReferenceObject, MapPosition, NatoCommGovRefObj	Yes
PmAction	Pm Action	PM	PM_ACTION	PM_ACTION_API	Get_Action_Descr	DocReferenceObject	Yes
DiscGrievParticipants	Disciplinary and Grievanc	PERSON	DISC_GRIEV_PARTICIPANT	DISC_GRIEV_PARTICIPANT		DocReferenceObject	Yes
EmpPaymentTrans	Employee Payment Trans	EMPPAY	EMP_PAYMENT_TRANS	EMP_PAYMENT_TRANS_A		DocReferenceObject	Yes
LotBatchMaster	Lot Batch Master	PARTCA	LOT_BATCH_MASTER	LOT_BATCH_MASTER_API		DocReferenceObject, TechnicalObjectReference	Yes
ManufacturerInfo	Manufacturer Info	ENTERP	MANUFACTURER_INFO	MANUFACTURER_INFO_A	Get_Doc_Object_Descript	MapPosition, NatoCommGovRefObj	Yes
SalesContract	Sales Contract	CONMGT	SALES_CONTRACT	SALES_CONTRACT_API	Get_Object_Description	ChangeObjectConnection, DocReferenceObject, RiskReferenceObject	Yes
SerialFault	Serial Fault	VIM	SERIAL_FAULT	SERIAL_FAULT_API	Get_Fault_Desc	DocReferenceObject, MediaLibrary	Yes
ServiceQuotation	Service Quotation	SERVQUO	SERVICE_QUOTATION	SERVICE_QUOTATION_API		DocReferenceObject	Yes

Column	Description
Logical Unit	The name of the logical unit/entity where the view is defined.
Description	The description of the logical unit/entity.
Component	The component (module) of the logical unit/entity.
View Name	The name of the view that describes the object to be connected to the services.
Package Name	The name of PL/SQL package that handles the data in the LU.
Method Name	The name of the method in the package to return a nice description to be used in the connection dialog.
Service List	The list of services that the logical unit/entity may use and connect to.
Default Definition	Yes if the logical unit/entity has a default setup of connected services (modeled services). The default services are the ones that will become available during the installation but may be changed in runtime and added/removed by the administrator.

If the logical unit/entity for the object that you want to connect is not show in the list, you will have to add a *New* connection.

Simply press *New* and fill in needed fields in the *Create Object Connection* assistant by choosing the Logical Unit and select the service(s) from the *Available Services* list.

Available Services

Below you'll find a sample list of standard services available in IFS Cloud. The aim is to keep this list updated in order to always reflect the most current IFS Cloud version. Each product/solution in IFS Cloud providing these type of services also contains information/documentation about supported/available services. Please refer to the product specific documentation for more details about these services.

For the Object Name	You enter the Service List	Comment/Description
Approval Routing	ApprovalRouting	Electronic sign off ('flexible workflow') however an in-completed approval from this tab does not stop the object from being used or the order progressed etc.
Characteristics	TechnicalObjectReference	Engineering technical attribute definition based on a technical class - used in the Best Fit Search Wizard feature (not to be confused with the 'normal' characteristics tab of information that is available within some forms as a tab on the main form.
Document	DocReferenceObject	Enables the ability to attach new and existing documents, with access to document management features.
Document Requirement	DocRequirementObject	By document class what documents are required, more typically used in Project Management.
Engineering Requests	EcrObjectConn	It is possible to create new and change existing change request information (no Zoom facility defined).
Engineering Change Orders	EcoActionObjectConn	Can add (by using Zoom) or link to an existing Change Order which must have action and order lines defined already,

For the Object Name	You enter the Service List	Comment/Description
		no action commands defined from the connected object view but a custom menu could be set up.
Linear Asset Element	LinastElementObjectConn	Possibility to connect any LU to Linear Asset Elements.
Nato Commercial Government Reference Object	NatoCommGovRefObj	IFS Aviation & Defense extension related. Similar to Dunn&Bradstreet NATO assigns a unique code to all the enterprises involved in supplying and managing its assets. NCAGE code is the NATO Commercial and Government Entity and can be specified by using this connected object. Connection is only relevant against the following objects: Company, Customer, Supplier, Manufacturer, Owner, Forwarder and Site.
Call Center Case	CcCaseObjectConnection	Use the Case Wizard from an Object and raise a new Case. Many Cases can be raised against the same object. The “connected” box is ticked on the Case heading in Call Centre to indicate this. In addition to the activation in Solution Manager there is specific set up in Call Centre as well. The user/assignee must be linked to a Work Group and this same Work group must be assigned to the Case Issue that has the ‘connected object’ option activated. If this is not done although the Case tab will be displayed the Wizard to open a new case will not be active. It is the exact Logical Unit name that needs to be used in the Case Issue set up.

For the Object Name	You enter the Service List	Comment/Description
Risk	RiskReferenceObject	Existing Risk analysis Headers can be attached or detached. It is possible to navigate to Object details.
Risk Assessment	RiskObjectConnection	This service allows data from the logical unit to be used in the Risk Assessment window. It enables contents of the LU (e.g., incident cases, work orders, company sites) to be linked directly to relevant risk assessments. The connection is then performed on the Connect To tab.
GIS Integration Connections	GisintConnections	Possibility to show any LU on a GIS map.
Map Positions	MapPosition	Enables the map positioning service for an object in which business objects can be placed at positions on a map. Define the longitude and latitude of the business object in the data grid view or navigate to a location in the map view and add a position for the business object on the map.
Map Positions Free	MapPositionFree	Enables a free attachment map, based on Esri's ArcGIS platform.
Media Library	MediaLibrary	Create a media library, which is a collection of media items, for the specific object.
Incident Reporting	IncidentObjectConnection	Related with Health & Safety functionality. Enabling "Incident Reporting" would facilitate to attach any of the created incidents to an object or by invoking the Incident Report Assistant, an incident can be reported while working on another object. Incident object can be connected to a

For the Object Name	You enter the Service List	Comment/Description
		specific IFS business object via the Object Connections window. When connected, it can be viewed from both the Incident window Connected To tab and the Object Connections window Attachments panel.
Audit Management	AuditObjectConnection	Enables connecting existing quality audits and adding new quality audits through the New Audit assistant, for the specific object. It is possible to view the object connections directly from the Connected To tab in the Audit page. Audit object can be connected to a specific IFS business object via the Object Connections page. When connected, it can be viewed from both the Audit page Connected To tab and the Object Connections page Attachments panel.
Corrective and Preventive Action	CapaObjectConnection	Enables connecting existing corrective and preventive actions and adding new corrective and preventive actions through the New Corrective and Preventive Action assistant, for the specific object. It is possible to view the object connections directly from the Connected To tab in the Corrective and Preventive Action page. Corrective and Preventive Action object can be connected to a specific IFS business object via the Object Connections page. When connected, it can be viewed from both the Corrective and Preventive Action page Connected To tab and the Object Connections page Attachments panel.
Non Conformance	NcrObjectConnection	Enables connecting existing non conformance reports and adding new

For the Object Name	You enter the Service List	Comment/Description
Report		non conformance reports through the New Non Conformance Report assistant, for the specific object. It is possible to view the object connections directly from the Connected To tab in the Non Conformance Report page. Non Conformance Report object can be connected to a specific IFS business object via the Object Connections page. When connected, it can be viewed from both the Non Conformance Report page Connected To tab and the Object Connections page Attachments panel.
IoT	lotObrOprLog	This is to identify the records created from IoT Observations. (To create records from an IoT Observation, first you need to enable the particular entity to fetch data from IoT.)
Feedback	FeedbackObjectConnection	Enables connecting existing Feedback, stored in Feedback Hubs and sending feedback through the Send Feedback Assistant, for the specific object. Feedback object can be connected to a specific IFS business object via the Object Connections page.
Event Log	EventLog	Enables the event log for the specified entity (logical unit). The event log will display automatically captured events and will also allow you to enter manual events.
Digital Signatures	DssDocumentRefObject	Enables viewing Digital Signatures attached to the specific logical unit. They can be viewed in the Signed Document Details page as an admin user with the FND_DSS_ASST_ADMIN permission set granted, or they can be

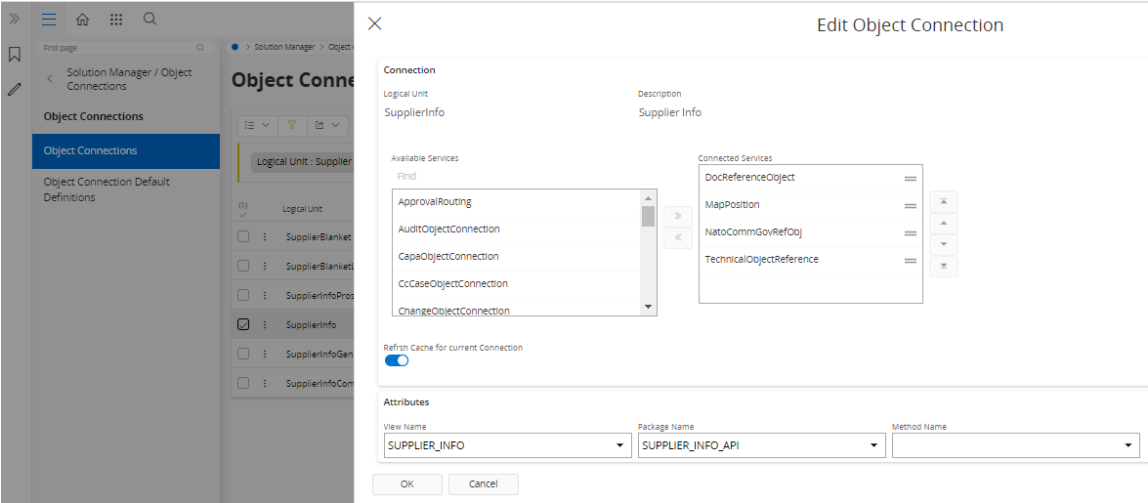
For the Object Name	You enter the Service List	Comment/Description
		viewed in the Digital Signatures attachment panel for pages attached to the enabled logical unit for end users with the FND_DSS_ASST_ENDUSER permission set granted. This allows users to validate and download the signed documents and also get access to the validation report.

The entry must be typed exactly as displayed. The items in the service list are logical units that can act as connectors to specific objects. The framework does not support the addition of a service to another service. For example, you should not add any services to the DocReferenceObject LU as it is a service itself.

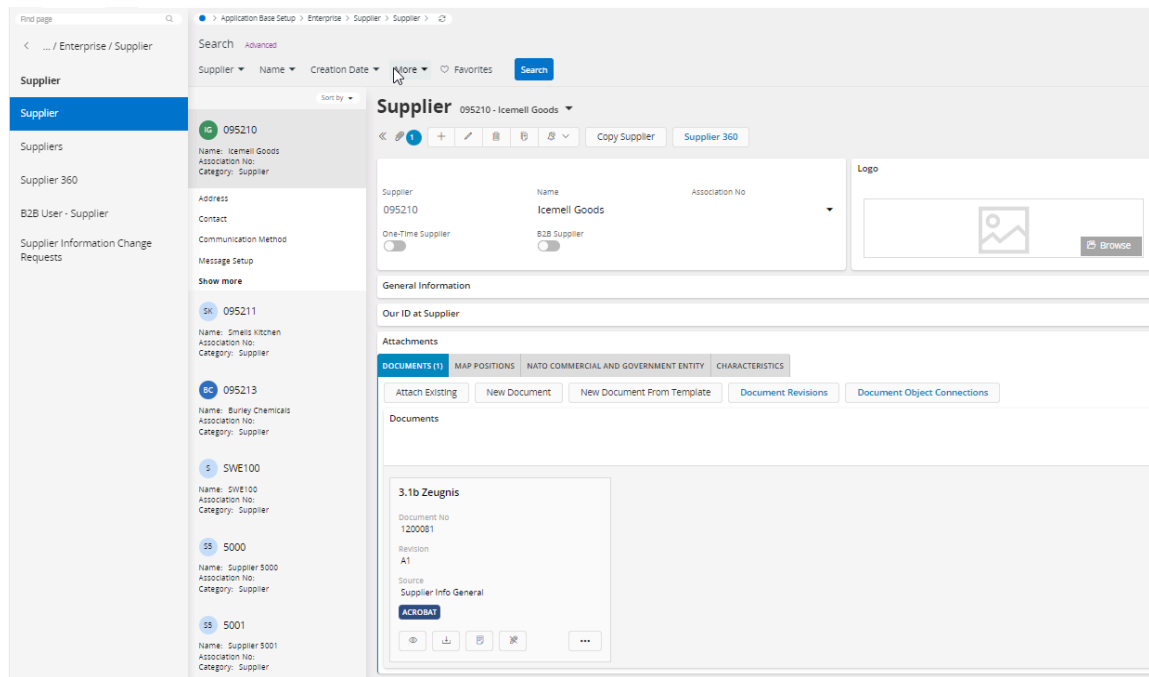
How to create/edit Object Connections

Entering an Object Connection in IFS Solution Manager.

Open the Object Connections page and press "New" to create a new Object Connection (or "Edit" to change an existing one).



A page connected to the specified Logical Unit, View and Package will get the services according to the service list (Connected Services). These services will be shown in the Attachment section of a page.



The available Attachments are controlled by the object connection service list.

Technical Notes

All available services are registered during install-time and can be listed as Available Services in the Create/Edit Object Connections assistant.

Typically, object connections are defined by being modeled but can also be programmatically created using public interfaces in `Object_Connection_SYS`.

- Read more about **Using object connections** in the development guide.